## PROJECT OVERVIEW

Welcome to project Midas!

The goal of this project is to create a Golden Dataset that will be used to evaluate how well models perform on answering document-based questions.

Your goal in this task is to write a factual financial-related prompt based on a 10-K/10-Q SEC filing from a pre-selected company, answer to the prompt you've created and write the supporting facts from the document. A typical project workflow will be:

1. Select a company that belongs to your **pre- assigned industry segment**
2. Select **ONE** 10-K **OR** 10-Q from the company you chose and download it and upload it here.
3. Write a Factual Prompt whose answer MUST be present in the document. Depending on the type of prompt you were assigned, it can be:
    a. Simple Prompt: a simple question that can be directly extracted from the document.
    b. Complex Prompt: a complex question that involves logical reasoning, computing numbers, etc.
4. Write a Perfect Answer that addresses your prompt
5. Write all the Supporting Facts that were used to write your Perfect Answer and their full Location in the document.
6. Write a Rationale to provide all steps taken to get to your Perfect Answer.

Detailed instructions for each step of the tasks will be provided below. If this is your first time working on this project you **MUST READ THROUGH ALL THE INSTRUCTIONS** carefully. **Quality** is the most important aspect of this project, and you can log the time taken to understand the task, so please read the entire instructions. Low-quality tasks where workers demonstrate to not follow the instructions are grounds for removal from this project!

## GROUND RULES

**NO EXTERNAL LLM IS ALLOWED** to assist, address or generate ANY portion of this task. Do not use any LLMs or chatbot tools (e.g., ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Perplexity, local LLMs, etc) to help you. If we wanted LLM generated content we wouldn't be asking you to work on this task in the first place. We are truly interested in your high-valued knowledge and work to develop premium prompt-response pairs! ❤️

Any LLM usage are grounds for removal from this project AND from DataAnnotation. We have ways to detect this, it's not worth the risk!

**VERY IMPORTANT:** ONLY USE SEC FILINGS PUBLISHED FROM **OCTOBER 2023 OR MORE RECENT**.

**DO NOT INCLUDE ANY PERSONALLY IDENTIFIABLE INFORMATION (PII)** in ANY portion of your Prompt or Answer. SEC filings are public, heavily regulated documents that intentionally disclose the names, salaries, and backgrounds of top executives. Therefore, not all names are considered prohibited PII. The goal of your PII restriction is to prevent the AI from memorizing and later generating sensitive personal data of ordinary individuals or private contact information. Here is a breakdown of what's allowed or not:

🚫 **STRICTLY PROHIBITED (Treat as PII)**

- Direct email addresses (e.g.," j.smith@company.com")
- Direct phone numbers or personal extensions
- Home addresses or private physical locations (even if tangentially mentioned in legal proceedings)
- Names of ordinary employees, middle managers, or rank-and-file workers.
- Names of whistleblowers or plaintiffs in HR-related lawsuits against the company.
- Names of individual retail investors mentioned in proxy contexts or minority shareholder lawsuits.
- Account numbers, Social Security Numbers (SSN), or tax IDs (which should never be in a 10-K anyway, but sometimes leak in attached exhibits).
- Specific medical conditions or health statuses of executives (e.g., if a CEO takes a leave of absence and the 10-K names the specific illness).
- Details about an executive's family members (spouses, children) sometimes mentioned in related-party transaction disclosures.

✅ **PERMITTED (Do NOT Treat as PII)**

Because this is a financial analysis project, restricting all names would make the dataset useless. You **are allowed** to use the following, as they are public, material facts to the business:

- Names of the CEO, CFO, COO, CTO, etc. (e.g., Tim Cook, Satya Nadella).
- Names of the Board of Directors.
- Salaries, stock options, and bonuses of the named executive officers (NEOs) explicitly detailed in the filing.
- Names of external auditing firms (e.g., PwC, Deloitte).
- Names of major institutional shareholders (e.g., Vanguard, BlackRock) or partner companies.
- General corporate contact information (e.g., the company's main HQ address or the generic investor_relations@company.com inbox).

## WRITING FACTUAL PROMPTS

A good prompt is the heart of this project, so let's make sure yours is built to last! The goal here is to write the kind of financial-related rigorous question that a real analyst would ask before or while reviewing a SEC filing. It must be **atomic, specific, grounded in the document, and with one clear correct answer** (the Ground Truth).

Before we dive into the specifics, here are the rules that apply no matter what type of prompt you were assigned:

✅ **Your prompt MUST:**

- **Be atomic**. This means your prompt must contain a SINGLE question only.
- **Be strictly financial or accounting-based**. Focus on revenues, margins, cash flows, debt structures, asset turnover, tax reconciliations, company/segment performance, not on opinions.
- **Be natural and realistic**, as if you were asking a question to a fellow finance analyst and like a real technical person would do.
- **Be grounded in the document**, answerable using **ONLY** the SEC document you uploaded.
- **Be factual**, that is, ask for factual financial data, such as numbers, percentages, or accounting policies.
- **Be specific** enough that there is only one correct mathematical or accounting answer. Do not make vague questions like *"How did the company's finances perform?"*

❌ **Your prompt MUST NOT:**

- Focus on non-financial trivia (e.g., "How many employees does the company have?", "Where is the headquarters located?", or "Who is the CEO?" ❌. these do not test the AI's financial reasoning).
- Ask for investment advice or stock predictions or opinion(e.g., "Is this company a good buy based on its P/E ratio?" ❌).
- Be answerable from general financial knowledge alone without reading the filing. (e.g., "What is the formula for Free Cash Flow?" ❌).
- **Target any images**. They must only target selectable texts, tables, paragraphs, etc.
- Include any **personally identifiable information (PII)**. If your Supporting Facts somehow references a PII, you need to redact it. For example, if a citation includes a specific employee lawsuit, use placeholders like [Employee Name]. We **highly recommend** avoiding this situation, though!

This is especially important: **UNDER ANY CIRCUMSTANCES, DO NOT RE-USE PROMPTS**. The purpose of this project is to create a high-quality **DIVERSE** data-set, so

submissions from the same worker where the prompts are equal or very similar will be flagged as BAD and you will be removed from the project.

There are two types of prompts you might be assigned: **Simple Prompts** and **Complex Prompts**. Your prompt must match the requirements of the one you were assigned. Carefully read the section below to better understand the difference between them.

## SIMPLE PROMPTS

A **Simple Prompt** is a financial question whose answer can be extracted directly from one specific location in the document, like an information retrieval. For instance, it could be the information contained in one table cell, one line item, one footnote, or a financial conclusion, etc. **It must not require any math or calculation** to be answered; it is a test of finding the exact right number in a dense financial report.

**What makes a great Simple Prompt?**

A great **Simple Prompt** targets financial items that require navigating past the cover page and into the core financial statements (Balance Sheet, Income Statement, Cash Flow) or the Management's Discussion and Analysis (MD&A). Look for:

- Specific line items buried in tables (e.g., Amortization of intangible assets, specific debt maturities).
- Segment-specific financial data (e.g., revenue for a specific product line, not just total revenue).
- Disclosed financial risk figures (e.g., the exact dollar amount of foreign exchange headwinds reported).

**The Retrieval Test**: After writing your question, test yourself: could you point to a single number or highlight a single passage in the PDF that answers it without any calculation? If yes, you have a great **Simple Prompt**!

## COMPLEX PROMPTS

A **Complex Prompt** is a question that cannot be answered by finding a single sentence or table cell. Instead, answer to this question **MUST satisfy ONE OR MORE** of the following conditions:

- Computing a number **that is not explicitly stated** (e.g., calculating a margin, a growth rate, a ratio)
- Combining information **from multiple sections of the same document** (e.g., using a number from a table on page 40 and a footnote clarification on page 43)

- Applying financial domain knowledge to interpret the data (e.g., "exclude a one-time charge" from a loss)

**What makes a great Complex Prompt?**

A great **Complex Prompt** has a clear, singular correct answer, but requires genuine analytical effort to get there. The ideal question is one where a smart person without financial training would struggle, but a trained financial professional would solve it methodically.

**The complexity Test**: Before submitting a Complex Prompt, ask yourself:

- Does answering this require reading at least two different parts of the document?
- Does it require performing a calculation that isn't already stated in the document?
- Would a financial professional get this right while a non-specialist might make a mistake?

If you answered yes to at least two of the three, that's a top-tier **Complex Prompt**!

**PROMPT EXAMPLES**

In the table below there are some examples of good and bad prompts for each category. Feel free to refer to them before you write your prompt or whenever you are in doubt if your prompt fits the project's criteria:

| Category & Definition | ❌ BAD Examples (Why they fail) | ✅ GOOD Examples (Why they work) |
|---|---|---|

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Simple Prompts**<br><br>*Extracting a single, specific fact or number directly from one place in the document. No math required.* | **1.** "What does Microsoft do to make money?"<br>*(Too vague, asks for a general summary instead of a fact).*<br><br>**2.** "Was Pfizer sued recently?"<br>*(Lazy Yes/No question; doesn't test the AI's ability to find financial data).*<br><br>**3.** "Does Tesla spend a lot on R&D?"<br>*("A lot" is subjective and cannot be factually measured).* | **1.** "Based on Microsoft's FY2023 10-K, what was the exact total revenue generated by the 'Intelligent Cloud' segment?"<br>*(Targets a specific, indisputable number found in one table).*<br><br>**2.** "According to Pfizer's FY2023 10-K, what was the exact dollar amount recorded as a litigation settlement charge in the third quarter?"<br>*(Pinpoints a specific legal disclosure).*<br><br>**3.** "What was Tesla's total Research and Development (R&D) expense for the fiscal year 2023?"<br>*(Simple, direct extraction of a specific line item).* |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Complex Prompts**<br><br>*Requires combining facts from multiple paragraphs in the same document, inferring context, or doing math.* | **1.** "What was Microsoft's cloud revenue, and what was their cloud cost?" *(This is just two Simple Prompts glued together. No math or reasoning required).*<br><br>**2.** "How much did Pfizer make in revenue and how much did they pay for lawsuits?" *(Compound question that asks two unrelated simple things).*<br><br>**3.** "How many employees does Tesla have and what is their R&D expense?" *(Again, just extracting two separate things without connecting them logically).* | **1.** "Based on Microsoft's FY2023 10-K, what was the Gross Profit Margin percentage for the 'Intelligent Cloud' segment?" *(Requires finding revenue and cost, then applying the gross margin formula).*<br>**2.** "If you exclude the Q3 litigation settlement charge from Pfizer's FY2023 operating expenses, what would their Adjusted Operating Margin have been?" *(Requires finding the charge, mathematically removing it from expenses, and recalculating the margin).*<br><br>**3.** "Based on the FY2023 10-K, what was Tesla's average R&D expenditure per full-time employee?" *(You need to find the R&D total, find the total headcount, and divide them).* |

## WRITING PERFECT ANSWERS

Alright! Now that you have a Perfect Prompt, it's time to write the **Perfect Answer**. Think of this as the ultimate "answer key". In the future, this exact text will be used as the Ground Truth for other raters to evaluate whether the model's answer is correct or not.

Your answer should be exactly how you would want a highly competent fellow financial analyst to reply to your question.

**What makes a Perfect Answer?**

**1. Be direct and concise**
Answer the question immediately. Do not add conversational fluff, filler words, or extra information that the prompt didn't ask for. If the prompt asks for revenue, do not include in your answer the net income just because it was in the same table!

- ❌ **Bad:** *"*Well, according to the table on page 42 of the document, the total revenue was $45 million, and they also had $10 million in operating expenses which is interesting.*"* (Too conversational, includes unnecessary extra facts).

- ✅ **Good:** *"*The total revenue was $45 million.*"*

**2.Use full sentences**
While we want you to be concise, the answer must still be a complete, readable sentence. A reader should know exactly what the answer means without needing to look back at the prompt (it must be self-contained!). A good way to validate  this is to pretend you are someone that don't know what the prompt is and see if you could guess it by only looking at your response.

- ❌ **Too brief:** "45.2%."

- ✅ **Self-Contained:** "The Gross Profit Margin for the Intelligent Cloud segment was 45.2%."

**3. Be fanatical about units and formats**
SEC filings love to play tricks with units (e.g., writing "45" at the top of a table that says *in millions*). Your **Perfect Answer** must state the true number with **absolute clarity**.

- ❌ **Bad:** "The revenue was 45." (45 what? Dollars? Apples?)

- ✅ **Good:** "The total revenue was $45 million." (or $45,000,000).

**4. Always try ground your answer in time**
SEC filings compare multiple years of data (e.g., a 2023 10-K will also show 2022 and 2021 numbers). Even if your prompt mentions the year, your **Perfect Answer** must explicitly restate the specific year, quarter, or date the data belongs to. This prevents the answer from becoming factually incorrect if read out of context (once again, it must be self-contained!).

- ❌ **Bad:** "The total R&D expense was $3.2 billion." (For which year? 2023? 2022?)

- ✅ **Good:** *"The total R&D expense for fiscal year 2023 was $3.2 billion."*

**5. Respect the PII Rules strictly**
Remember the Ground Rules! If your answer involves a specific employee below the C-suite level or a private individual (like a whistleblower in a lawsuit mentioned in the 10-K), **you must redact their name or avoid including it in the answer**

- ❌ **Bad:** *"The company paid a $2M settlement to former HR manager John Merry."*

- ✅ **Good:** *"The company paid a $2M settlement to a former HR manager."*

**IMPORTANT:** By convention, for this project, any **percentage data must be rounded to the closest first decimal place and money figures must be rounded to the closest integer.**

**PROMPT EXAMPLES**

The following table has some PERFECT and BAD answers. We recommend you to always consult this table of reference before building

| Prompt Type | The Question | ❌ BAD Answers (Why they fail) | ✅ PERFECT Answers (Why they work) |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Simple Prompt** | *"Based on Microsoft's FY2023 10-K, what was the exact total revenue generated by the 'Intelligent Cloud' segment?"* | **"$87.9 billion."**<br><br>*(Fails: Not a complete sentence).*<br><br>**"It was $87.9 billion, and the gaming segment made $15 billion."**<br><br>*(Fails: Gives extra info not asked for).* | **"The total revenue generated by the Intelligent Cloud segment in FY2023 was $87.9 billion."**<br><br>*(Works: Complete, direct, and includes the correct financial unit).* |
| **Complex Prompt** | *"If you exclude the Q3 litigation settlement charge from Pfizer's FY2023 operating expenses, what would their Adjusted Operating Margin have been?"* | **"If you take the $12B revenue and divide it by the adjusted loss, it's 24%."**<br><br>*(Fails: Do not put your math scratchpad in the final answer).*<br><br>**"Based on my analysis of the SEC filing, I believe the margin is around 24%."**<br><br>*(Fails: Too conversational and subjective).* | **"Excluding the Q3 litigation settlement charge, Pfizer's Adjusted Operating Margin for FY2023 would have been 24.0%."**<br><br>*(Works: Clean, professional, and states the final calculated number clearly).* |

It's worth noticing that you will show your mathematical work (for **Complex Prompts)** and cite your evidence in the upcoming **Supporting Facts** and **Rationale** sections. The Answer box is just for the final response (the Ground Truth)!

## HOW TO PROVIDE SUPPORTING FACTS

In the future, other raters will need to verify your answer **WITHOUT HAVING TO READ THE ENTIRE SEC filing from scratch**. Your Supporting Facts are the only available information they get. If you don't provide the **Supporting Facts**, the rater will not be able to fulfill their task!

In the taskworkflow, you will see a specific form to fill out for each fact you need to prove your answer. You can add as many facts as you need by clicking the "Add" button. You'll always need to fill the following fields:

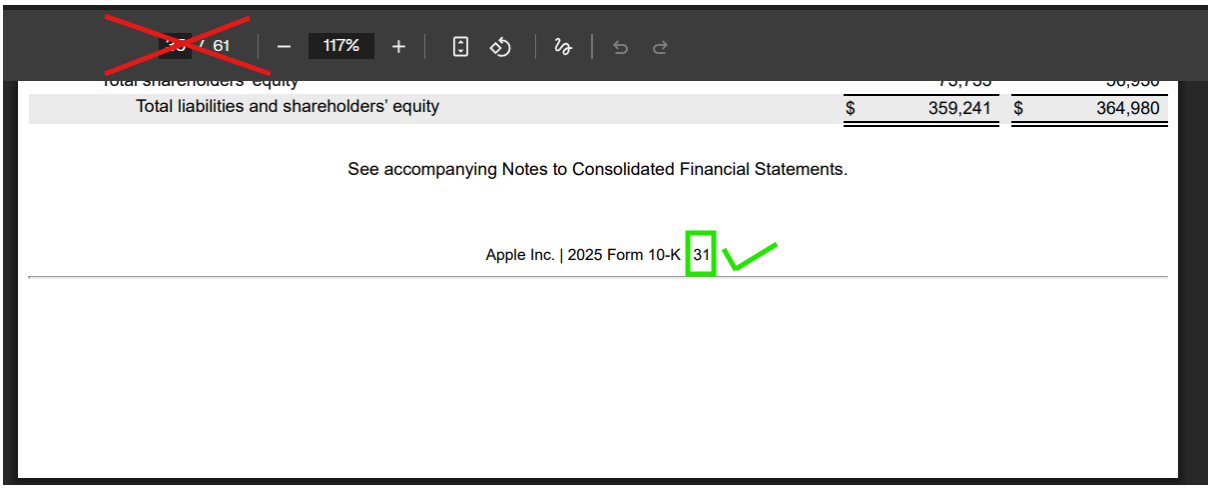
**1. Evidence (Verbatim Copy-Paste Only!)**
This is the most important rule in the entire project. You must highlight the **exact text** in the PDF; press Ctrl+ C, and paste it into this box. **Do not summarize it. Do not change the wording.** If the text has a typo in the original SEC filing, leave the typo in!

*Why?* Because AI models are evaluated on their ability to find exact text spans. If you paraphrase the evidence, the AI will fail the test because it can't find your version of the sentence in the document.

- TABLE EXCEPTION*:* If you are pulling a number from a heavily formatted table, it can look messy when pasted. **It's okay to use brackets** "[]" to add the column header context along with the verbatim row content, so that it makes sense.
  Example: *"iPad 28,023 5 % 26,694 (6)% 28,300 [Product, 2025, Change, 2024, Change, 2023]"*.
  Note that anything outside the "[]" is verbatim, with no changes (no commas anything, just as in the original pdf).

**2. Page Number**
Simply type the page number where you found the evidence.

**IMPORTANT:** Use the actual printed page number on the document itself, not the PDF viewer page number! The image below shows where you need to get the page number from:



**3. Page Section**
SEC filings are organized by "Items". Tell us exactly which section the fact lives in. For example: "Item 7. Management's Discussion and Analysis", "Item 1A. Risk Factors", or "Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements".

**4. Element Type**
You will select the format of the text you extracted from a dropdown list. Please choose the most accurate option:

- **Paragraph:** Standard text within the document.
- **Table:** A structured data presentation using a grid format
- **Footnote:** The small print usually found directly beneath a table or page, explaining a specific number or anomaly. (Pay close attention to these, they usually hold interesting facts!)
- **Heading / Subheading:** A section title.
- **List / Bullet Points:** A formatted list of items.

**IMPORTANT:** The amount of **Supporting Facts** will depend directly on the complexity of your prompts. If received a **Simple Prompt** task, it will likely have a **SINGLE** Supporting Fact; If you received a **Complex Prompt**, you'll NECESSARILY have 2 or more Supporting Facts. Remember, you need to state **EVERY SINGLE** piece of information needed to answer your Prompt without depending on the document.

**EXAMPLE OF A PERFECT SUPPORTING FACT FILLING**

**Your Prompt:**
"Based on Apple's FY2025 10-K, what was the average annual revenue generated by the iPad segment over the three-year period from 2023 to 2025?"

**Your Answer:**
"The average annual revenue generated by the iPad segment from 2023 to 2025 was $27,672 million."

**Supporting Facts Form:**

FACT 1 (Proving the 3-Year Data)

**Evidence:** "iPad 28,023 5 % 26,694 (6)% 28,300 [Product, 2025, Change, 2024, Change, 2023]"
(Notice what the worker did here! They copy-pasted the exact, messy string of text as it came out of the PDF: iPad 28,023 5 % 26,694 (6)% 28,300. Then, they added brackets [ ] at the end containing the column headers in the exact order they appear in the table.)

**Page Number:** 24

**Page Section:** Item 7. Management's Discussion and Analysis (Net Sales by Product)

**Element Type:** Table

Though this is a **Complex Prompt** (it needs to calculate an average based on several values), note how the worker only needed to pull ONE row from the Net Sales table to fully contain all numbers in a single evidence. This is OK. Also, note how the PDF copy-paste is messy and to clarify this they use brackets to map the column headers to the numbers in the exact order data points are shown.

**WRITING YOUR RATIONALES**

If you are working on a **Simple Prompt**, you can skip this section entirely! Leave the Rationale box blank.

If you are working on a **Complex Prompt**, this is where you'll learn about rationales!

The Rationale is the step-by-step logic that connects your raw Supporting Facts to your Perfect Answer. Why do we need this? Because if your Perfect Answer is "24.5%", and your facts are just the numbers $100M and $24.5M, **a rater needs to know how exactly you arrived at that percentage**. We cannot guess your math! The basic rules of rationale writing are stated below

**1. Spell Out the Formula**
Do not assume the reviewer knows the exact financial formula you are using. Different companies sometimes calculate things like "Free Cash Flow" or "Adjusted Margin" slightly differently. Always write out the formula in plain English before plugging the numbers in.

❌ **Bad:** "I divided 100 by 400 to get 25%." *(Divided what by what?)*

✅ **Good:** "Gross Margin = (Total Revenue - Cost of Revenue) / Total Revenue."

**2. Show the Step-by-Step Math (Including Conversions)**
You must write down the actual arithmetic. The most common mistake we see is people messing up the decimals because SEC filings report in *millions* or *thousands*. If you had to convert units or move a decimal point to get a percentage, show it!

❌ **Bad:** "24,500 / 100,000 = 24.5%."

✅ **Good:** "Step 1: 24,500 (Cost) / 100,000 (Revenue) = 0.245. Step 2: Convert to percentage = 24.5%."

**3. Explain the "Why" (The Hidden Logic)**
**Complex Prompts** usually have a "trick", like excluding a one-time charge, or finding a number buried in a footnote. Your rationale must explicitly state *why* you chose the numbers you did. Explain your logic as if you are training a junior analyst on their first day.

❌ **Bad:** "I took the loss of -$3,690 and added $350. Then divided by $1,700." (Why did you add $350? A reviewer won't know unless they memorize the document!)

✅ **Good:** "Because the prompt asked for the 'Adjusted' Operating Margin, I had to remove the one-time $350M restructuring charge (found in Fact 3). To remove an expense from an

operating loss, you must mathematically add it back to the bottom line: -3,690 + 350 = -3,340."

**EXAMPLE OF A PERFECT TASK**

Let's take a look at how this all comes together!

**Your Prompt:**
"Based on the FY2023 10-K, what was Tesla's average Research and Development (R&D) expenditure per full-time employee?"

**Your Answer:**
"Tesla's average R&D expenditure per full-time employee in FY2023 was $28,214."

Suppose your Supporting Facts would have captured the $3.96B R&D expense (Fact 1) and the 140,473 employee count (Fact 2). Here's how your Rationale would look like:

"Goal: Find the average R&D spend per employee.
Formula: Total R&D Expense / Total Number of Employees.

**Logic & Math:**

From Fact 1, I found the Total R&D Expense is $3,964 million.

From Fact 2 , I found the total employee headcount is 140,473.

Since the R&D expense is reported in millions, I first need to convert it to actual dollars to divide it by the exact employee headcount. $3,964 million = $3,964,000,000.

Math: $3,964,000,000 / 140,473 employees = 28,218.946...

I rounded this to the nearest whole dollar: $28,219."

**TIME TO START YOUR TASK!**

That's it! You are now capable of producing high-quality **Factual Prompts**, **Perfect Answers**, as well as providing **Supporting Facts** and with great **Rationales**! Your task assignment starts on the top right corner of this page!

If you have any doubts during this task, you may use the **Project Chat** at the bottom of this page, where Admins can answer you shortly.

**Thanks for your hard work!** ❤️